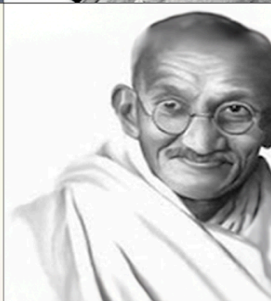


***General Knowledge***

***Modern History***

**STUDY NOTES**

**India After Freedom**

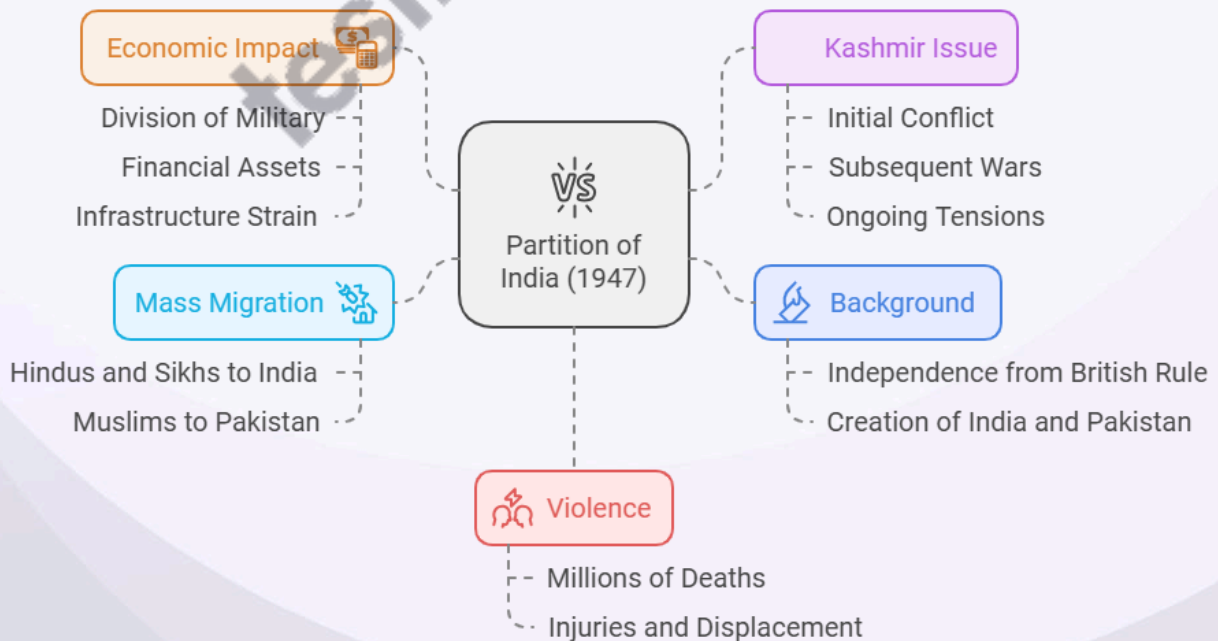


# India After Freedom

India's independence in 1947 marked a pivotal moment in world history. After nearly two centuries of British colonial rule, India gained its freedom on **August 15, 1947**, following a long and arduous struggle led by figures such as Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Chandra Bose, and many others. The independence of India was not only the end of British rule but also the beginning of a new era of self-governance, nation-building, and the pursuit of democracy, equality, and economic prosperity.

## Overview of India's Independence in 1947

- India's independence was achieved through a combination of non-violent resistance, civil disobedience, and negotiations with the British. The process culminated in the partition of India into **two separate nations, India and Pakistan**, which was a significant and controversial consequence of the independence movement. While the partition resulted in widespread violence, displacement, and human suffering, it also set the stage for the formation of the Indian Republic.
- India adopted a democratic constitution on **January 26, 1950**, marking the beginning of its democratic journey. **Jawaharlal Nehru became the first Prime Minister of independent India**, and the country embarked on its path as a sovereign nation.



## Partition and Its Impact on the Indian Subcontinent (1947)

- India gained independence from British rule on August 15, 1947. The partition led to the creation of two separate nations—India and Pakistan—along religious lines.
- **Impact:**
  - **Mass Migration:** The partition led to the mass displacement of people, with Hindus and Sikhs migrating to India and Muslims migrating to Pakistan.
  - **Violence:** Widespread communal violence resulted in millions of deaths and injuries.
  - **Economic Impact:** The division of resources, such as the military, financial assets, and infrastructure, strained both nations economically.
  - **Kashmir Issue:** The state of Jammu and Kashmir became a focal point for conflict between India and Pakistan, leading to several wars and ongoing tensions.

## Integration of Princely States into the Indian Union (1947-1949)

- **Background:** Upon independence, India consisted of British India and **565 princely states**, which had the option to join India, Pakistan, or remain independent.
- **Key Steps:**
  - **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel:** As the **first Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister**, Patel played a crucial role in convincing many rulers to accede to India.
  - **Instrument of Accession:** Princely states like **Jammu & Kashmir, Hyderabad, and Junagadh** initially resisted but were integrated through treaties and military intervention (in some cases).
  - **Hyderabad:** The region was annexed in **1948 after Operation Polo**, a military action to suppress the Nizam's refusal to join India.

## Adoption of the Constitution in 1950

- **Background:** India adopted its Constitution on **January 26, 1950**, after over two years of deliberations by the Constituent Assembly.
- **Key Features:**
  - **Democratic Republic:** India became a sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic with universal adult suffrage.
  - **Fundamental Rights:** The Constitution enshrined fundamental rights such as



equality, freedom of speech, and protection from discrimination.

- **Parliamentary System:** India adopted a parliamentary system of governance, with a President as the ceremonial head of state and a Prime Minister as the head of government.

## Reorganisation of States in India

### Introduction

- **Reorganisation of States** in India post-independence was formalized by the **State Reorganisation Act, 1956**, based on linguistic and administrative factors.
- Aimed to ensure better governance and accommodate regional, linguistic, and cultural aspirations.
- Followed public demand, particularly in South India, leading to the establishment of the **States Reorganisation Commission (SRC) in 1953**.

### Background

- **State Divisions in 1951:**
  - **Part A States (9):** Assam, West Bengal, Bihar, Bombay, Madhya Pradesh, Madras, Orissa, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh.
  - **Part B States (9):** Hyderabad, Jammu & Kashmir, Saurashtra, Mysore, Travancore-Cochin, Madhya Bharat, Vindhya Pradesh, PEPSU.
  - **Part C States (10):** Delhi, Kutch, Himachal Pradesh, Bilaspur, Coorg, Bhopal, Manipur, Ajmer, Cooch-Bihar, Tripura.
  - **Part D Territory (1):** Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

### Rationale Behind Reorganisation

- **Linguistic and Cultural Affiliations:**
  - Andhra Pradesh (1953) was the first linguistic state formed after Potti Sreeramulu's death.
  - Demands in regions like Bodoland (Assam) and Tripura for preserving cultural identities.
- **Tribal and Ethnic Identities:**
  - States like Nagaland addressed tribal aspirations.
- **Economic Development:**

- Separate states like Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand formed for better economic growth.
- **Administrative Viability:**
  - Smaller states like Uttarakhand created for improved governance.
- **Security Concerns:**
  - Jammu & Kashmir reorganized into two Union Territories (J&K and Ladakh) in 2019.

### Key Commissions Related to Reorganisation

- **Dhar Commission (1948):**
  - Rejected language as the primary basis for state reorganisation.
  - Focused on factors like administrative convenience and geographical continuity.
- **JVP Committee (1948):**
  - Members: Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, Pattabhi Sitaramayya.
  - Recommended delaying linguistic states but acknowledged public sentiment.
- **Fazl Ali Commission (1953):**
  - Accepted language as a factor but rejected "one language-one state."
  - Recommended 16 states and 3 Union Territories.
  - Basis for the State Reorganisation Act, 1956 and 7th Constitutional Amendment.

### New States and Union Territories Created After 1956

- **Maharashtra and Gujarat (1960):** Formed from the Bombay Reorganisation Act.
- **Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh (1966):** Punjab Reorganisation Act created separate states for linguistic and cultural groups.
- **Goa (1987):** Became a state; Daman & Diu remained a Union Territory.
- **Nagaland (1963):** Formed for Naga tribes' aspirations.
- **Manipur, Tripura, Meghalaya (1972):** Granted statehood from Union Territories.
- **Sikkim (1975):** Transitioned from associate state to full-fledged state.
- **Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand (2000):** Carved from Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, and Bihar, respectively.
- **Telangana (2014):** Separated from Andhra Pradesh.
- **Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh (2019):** Divided into two Union Territories.

## Major Wars and Conflicts

- **1962 Sino-Indian War:**
  - **Cause:** The war was fought over the disputed borders in the Himalayan region, particularly the Aksai Chin area.
  - **Outcome:** India suffered a significant defeat, losing territory in Aksai Chin, and the war highlighted India's lack of military preparedness.
- **1965 Indo-Pakistani War:**
  - **Cause:** The war was triggered by territorial disputes over Kashmir, particularly the Rann of Kutch region.
  - **Outcome:** The war ended in a stalemate with the Tashkent Agreement brokered by the Soviet Union, but it bolstered India's military and political standing.
- **1971 Indo-Pakistani War:**
  - **Cause:** This war was sparked by the Bangladesh Liberation War, where India intervened in support of the Bangladeshi independence movement.
  - **Outcome:** India decisively defeated Pakistan, leading to the creation of Bangladesh as an independent nation. The war greatly enhanced India's international standing.
- **Kargil War (1999):**
  - **Cause:** Pakistan infiltrated Kargil and other areas of Jammu & Kashmir, leading to a military confrontation.
  - **Outcome:** India successfully repelled the Pakistani forces, and the war reinforced India's military capabilities and its resolve to protect territorial integrity.

## Non-Alignment

### Introduction to Non-Alignment

- After India's independence, the global political environment shifted significantly due to the aftermath of World War II.
- Traditional powers like the **United Kingdom, France, Germany, and Japan** saw their empires diminish, while the **United States and the Soviet Union emerged as superpowers.**
- The Cold War polarized the world into two opposing blocs: **the US-led Western bloc and the USSR-led communist bloc.**
- Newly independent nations, mainly in Asia and Africa, sought paths that avoided

dependence on either bloc, leading to the concept of non-alignment.

### Principles of Non-Alignment

- Non-alignment focuses on non-interference in the domestic affairs of other nations.
- It emphasizes maintaining a country's sovereignty and independence.
- Post the **Bandung Conference (1955)**, the term 'non-alignment' gained prominence, symbolizing active neutrality.

### Five Criteria of Non-Alignment

- The Preparatory Committee of the first non-aligned conference outlined these criteria:
- Independent policy based on peaceful coexistence and non-alignment.
- Consistent support for national freedom movements in other countries.
- No membership in multilateral military alliances formed during superpower conflicts.
- Any military bases should not be granted in the context of superpower rivalries.
- Participation in bilateral or regional defense arrangements must not involve superpower conflicts.

### Pioneering Leaders of Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)

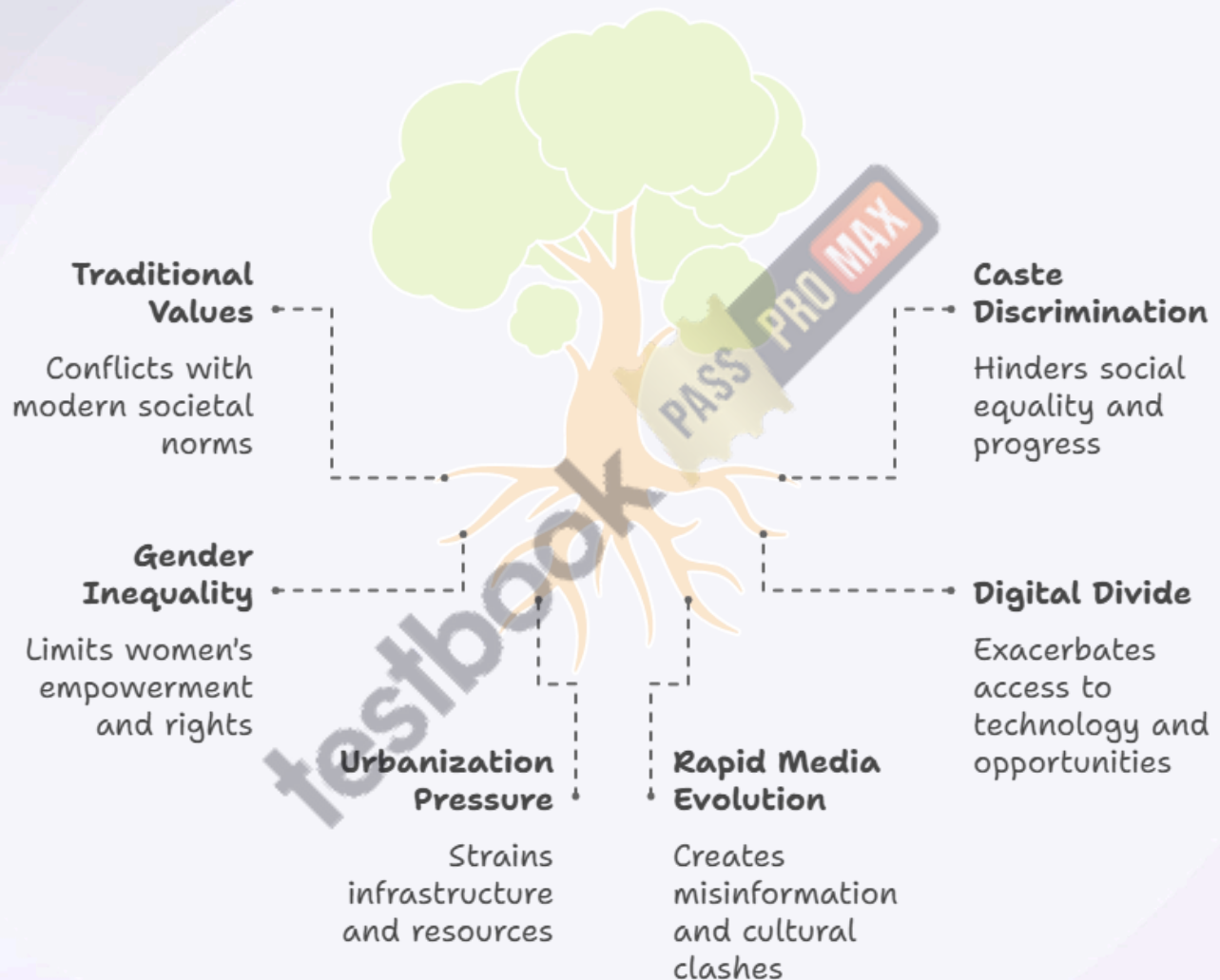
- **President Tito (Josip Broz) of Yugoslavia.**
- **President Gamal Abdel Nasser of Egypt.**
- **President Kwame Nkrumah of Ghana.**
- **President Sukarno of Indonesia.**
- **Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru of India.**

### Emergency in 1975

- **Background:** On June 25, 1975, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi declared a state of emergency, citing internal disturbances, and assumed extraordinary powers under Article 352 of the Indian Constitution.
- **Key Events:**
  - **Suspension of Civil Rights:** Fundamental rights were suspended, political leaders were imprisoned, and press censorship was imposed.
  - **Controversy:** The emergency is seen as a period of authoritarian rule, with widespread human rights abuses, forced sterilization programs, and curtailment of political freedoms.

- **End of Emergency:** The emergency ended in 1977 after Indira Gandhi called for general elections, which she lost. This event had a significant impact on Indian politics, leading to the rise of opposition movements.

### Cultural and Social Transformation Challenges



### Social and Cultural Developments:

#### Social Reform Movements and Their Impact:

- **Renaissance and Reform Movements:** In the 19th and early 20th centuries, India witnessed a wave of social reform movements aimed at addressing issues such



as caste discrimination, child marriage, female education, and the status of women. Key figures like **Raja Ram Mohan Roy**, **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**, and **Swami Vivekananda** contributed significantly to this era.

- **Brahmo Samaj** and **Arya Samaj**: These reform movements worked towards abolishing social evils, promoting rational thinking, and advocating for the upliftment of women and the lower castes. They also aimed to reconcile traditional Indian values with modernity.
- **The Dalit Movement**: Led by **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, this movement played a key role in the social and political upliftment of Dalits and fighting for their rights. Ambedkar's advocacy led to significant changes, such as the inclusion of provisions for the protection of Dalits in the Indian Constitution.

### **Growth of Education, Healthcare, and Infrastructure:**

- **Education**: The British colonial era saw the establishment of modern education systems. However, it was during the post-independence period that India's education sector began to grow rapidly. The **Right to Education Act (2009)** ensured free and compulsory education for children aged 6-14 years. Institutions like the **Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs)** and **Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs)** have become global benchmarks of excellence in education.
- **Healthcare**: The healthcare sector expanded significantly post-independence, with a focus on public health, sanitation, and the establishment of government hospitals. The **National Health Policy (2017)** aims to increase access to quality healthcare services.
- **Infrastructure**: The infrastructure in India has evolved with the development of roads, railways, airports, and cities. The **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)** and **Smart Cities Mission** are recent efforts to improve urban and rural infrastructure.

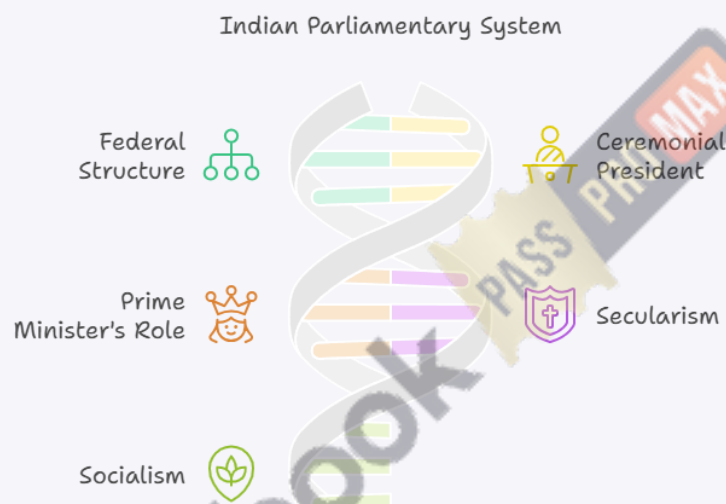
### **Evolution of Media and Entertainment (Bollywood, Print Media, etc.):**

- **Bollywood**: Indian cinema has evolved into one of the largest film industries in the world. Over the decades, Bollywood has reflected and influenced social issues, from family dynamics to societal struggles. The 1950s and 1960s were marked by socially relevant films, while the 1990s saw the emergence of Bollywood as an entertainment industry with global appeal.
- **Print Media**: The print media in India has a long history, dating back to the first newspaper, **The Bengal Gazette (1780)**. Post-independence, newspapers like **The Times of India**, **The Hindu**, and **The Indian Express** played a significant role in shaping public opinion. With the digital revolution, many of these newspapers have transitioned to online platforms.

- **Television:** The launch of **Doordarshan** in 1959 marked the beginning of television broadcasting in India. The 1990s saw a boom in private television channels like **Star TV**, **Zee TV**, and **Sony Entertainment**, which brought a variety of programming to Indian homes. Reality shows, news, and soap operas became staples of Indian television.

## Political developments in India

### Establishment of a Parliamentary Democracy



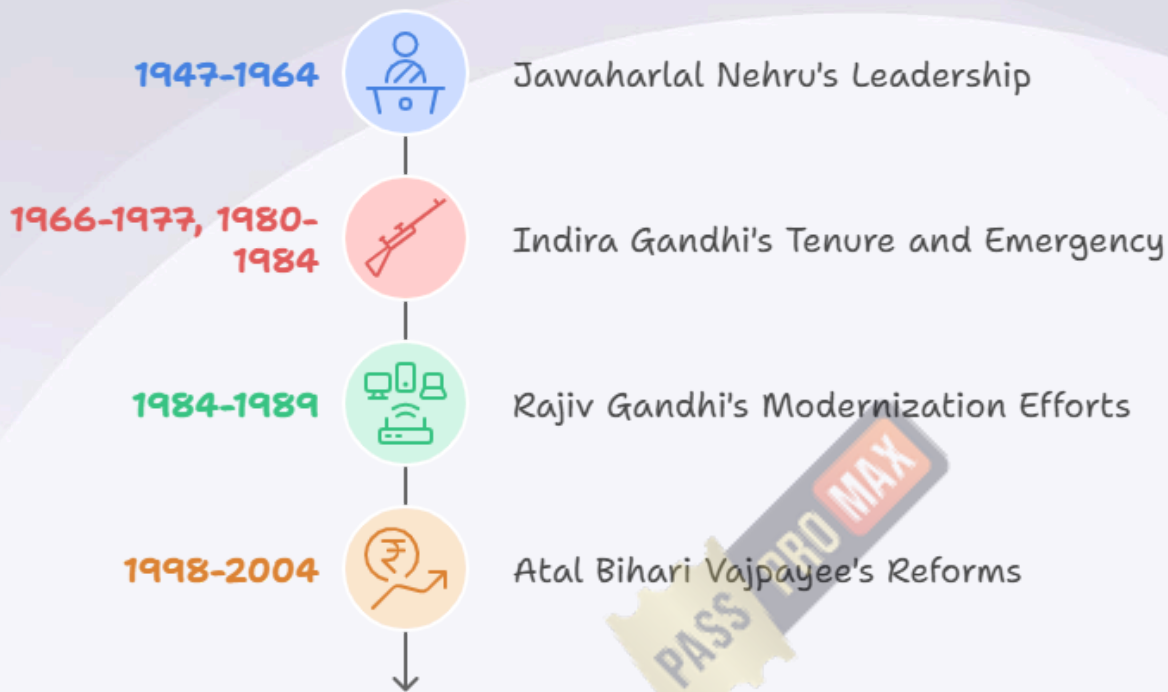
- **Post-Independence Constitution (1950):** India adopted a parliamentary system of governance, with a federal structure. The **Constitution of India** laid down the framework for governance, dividing powers between the Union and States. The President is the ceremonial head of state, while the **Prime Minister** is the head of government.
- **Secularism & Socialism:** The Constitution also emphasized secularism, democracy, and socialism, which shaped the country's political landscape.

**The first Council of Ministers of Independent India was -**

| Name                                  | Position                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Jawaharlal Nehru</b>               | Prime Minister; Minister of External Affairs and Commonwealth Relations; Minister of Scientific Research |
| <b>Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel</b>       | Deputy Prime Minister; Minister of Home Affairs and States; Minister of Information and Broadcasting     |
| <b>Maulana Abul Kalam Azad</b>        | Minister of Education                                                                                    |
| <b>John Mathai</b>                    | Minister of Railways and Transport                                                                       |
| <b>Sardar Baldev Singh</b>            | Minister of Defence                                                                                      |
| <b>Jairamdas Daulatram</b>            | Minister of Food and Agriculture                                                                         |
| <b>Jagjivan Ram</b>                   | Minister of Labour                                                                                       |
| <b>C.H. Bhabha</b>                    | Minister of Commerce                                                                                     |
| <b>Amrit Kaur</b>                     | Minister of Health                                                                                       |
| <b>Rafi Ahmad Kidwai</b>              | Minister of Communications                                                                               |
| <b>Narhar Vishnu Gadgil</b>           | Minister of Works, Mines, and Power                                                                      |
| <b>R.K. Shanmukham Chetty</b>         | Minister of Finance                                                                                      |
| <b>K.C. Neogy</b>                     | Minister of Relief and Rehabilitation                                                                    |
| <b>B.R. Ambedkar</b>                  | Minister of Law (Scheduled Castes Federation; resigned in 1951)                                          |
| <b>Shyama Prasad Mookherjee</b>       | Minister of Industries and Supplies (Hindu Mahasabha; resigned in April 1950)                            |
| <b>Narasimha Gopalaswami Ayyangar</b> | Minister without portfolio (link between union government and East Punjab government)                    |
| <b>Mohanlal Saxena</b>                | Minister without portfolio                                                                               |

**Political Leaders**

## Key Leaders Shaping India's Parliamentary Democracy



- **Jawaharlal Nehru (1947-1964)**: The first Prime Minister of independent India, Nehru was instrumental in shaping India's policies on economic development, foreign relations, and social justice. He established the Indian National Congress as the dominant political force and focused on state-led development.
- **Indira Gandhi (1966-1977, 1980-1984)**: Nehru's daughter, Indira Gandhi, became the Prime Minister and remained a towering political figure. She is noted for centralizing power and her decision to impose the **Emergency (1975-77)**, which curtailed civil liberties. She also led India to victory in the **1971 India-Pakistan War**, leading to the creation of Bangladesh.
- **Rajiv Gandhi (1984-1989)**: After Indira Gandhi's assassination, her son Rajiv Gandhi took over as Prime Minister. His tenure saw efforts to modernize India's infrastructure and liberalize the economy, though his tenure was marred by scandals.
- **Atal Bihari Vajpayee (1998-2004)**: A prominent leader of the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)**, Vajpayee served as Prime Minister three times. His tenure is marked by economic reforms, improved Indo-US relations, and nuclear tests in 1998, as well as initiatives for infrastructure development.

## Rise of Regional Parties and Their Influence

- **Regionalization of Politics**: Starting in the 1970s, India saw a significant rise in regional political parties. These parties, representing specific linguistic, ethnic, or cultural groups,



gained importance in states like Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, and Maharashtra.

- **Notable Regional Parties:**

- **Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)** and **AIADMK** in Tamil Nadu, playing key roles in state and national politics.
  - **Trinamool Congress (TMC)**, led by Mamata Banerjee in West Bengal.
  - **Samajwadi Party (SP)** and **Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)** in Uttar Pradesh.
- **Coalition Politics:** The rise of regional parties led to the decline of the Congress Party's dominance. In the 1990s, coalition governments became the norm at the Center, notably with the **United Front** government in the mid-1990s and the **National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** led by the BJP in the late 1990s and 2000s.

## Political Milestones

- **Formation of New States:**

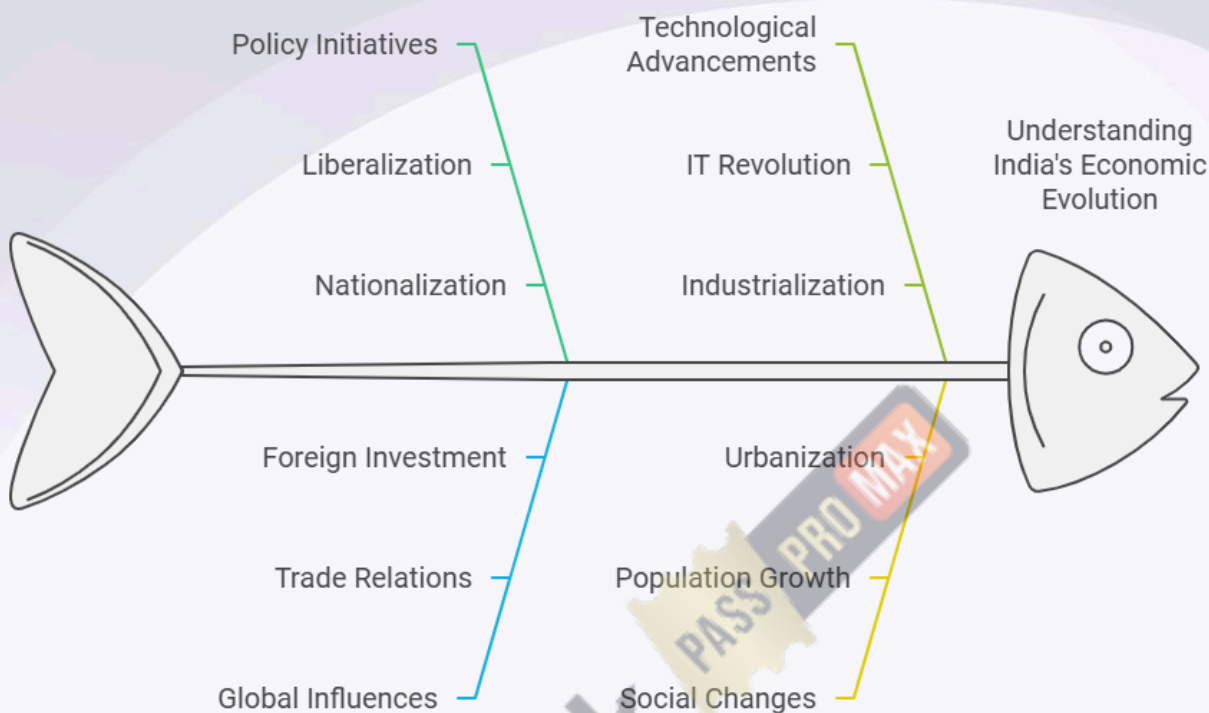
- **Creation of States:** India has witnessed the creation of new states, like **Haryana** (1966), **Himachal Pradesh** (1971), **Uttarakhand** (2000), **Chhattisgarh** (2000), and **Telangana** (2014). These changes were often driven by regional aspirations and demands for more localized governance.

- **Changes in Government Policies:**

- **Economic Reforms (1991):** Initiated by then-Finance Minister **Manmohan Singh** under the leadership of Prime Minister **P.V. Narasimha Rao**, these reforms liberalized the Indian economy, reduced import restrictions, and opened up the market to foreign investments, leading to significant economic growth.
- **Nuclear Policy:** In 1998, under **Atal Bihari Vajpayee**, India conducted nuclear tests at Pokhran, asserting its stance as a nuclear power.
- **Landmark Laws & Acts:** Significant reforms include the **Right to Information Act (2005)**, **Goods and Services Tax (GST, 2017)**, and **Right to Education Act (2009)**, which reshaped governance, taxation, and education policies.

## Economic Developments in India Post-Independence

## Analyzing India's Economic Growth Journey



### Nehru's Socialism (1947–1960s)

- **Policy Focus:** Post-independence, Jawaharlal Nehru emphasized **state control** over the economy and aimed to build a self-reliant India. The government took the lead in industrialization, with a focus on public sector enterprises and large-scale infrastructure projects.
- **Industrial Strategy:** Nehru adopted a **mixed economy model**, which included a combination of private and public sector involvement, with state-run industries in sectors like steel, heavy machinery, and energy.
- **Five-Year Plans:** The Planning Commission was established to frame **Five-Year Plans**, with emphasis on planned economic development. These plans focused on sectors like education, infrastructure, and heavy industry.
- **Challenges:** The emphasis on heavy industry and the public sector led to **slow growth** in the 1950s and 1960s, and India's economic growth lagged behind other developing countries.

### Green Revolution (1960s–1970s)

- **Objective:** The Green Revolution aimed at improving food security and agricultural

productivity in India. Introduced during the 1960s, it focused on **high-yielding varieties (HYVs)** of crops, chemical fertilizers, and modern irrigation techniques.

- **Impact:**
  - Led to a significant increase in the production of **wheat** and **rice**, especially in states like Punjab, Haryana, and Uttar Pradesh.
  - Helped India achieve **self-sufficiency in food grains** and reduce reliance on food imports.
- **Challenges:** The benefits were unevenly distributed, leading to regional disparities, and the increased use of chemicals led to environmental concerns.

## Economic Liberalization (1991)

- **Background:** By the early 1990s, India faced an economic crisis marked by a **balance of payments crisis**, **high fiscal deficits**, and **inflation**. In response, the government, led by **P.V. Narasimha Rao** and Finance Minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh**, initiated **economic reforms**.
- **Key Reforms:**
  - **Devaluation of the Rupee:** The rupee was devalued to correct trade imbalances and make exports more competitive.
  - **Reduction of Import Restrictions:** **Trade liberalization** included the reduction of tariffs and restrictions on imports.
  - **Privatization and Disinvestment:** The government began reducing its stake in public sector enterprises and encouraging private participation in the economy.
  - **Deregulation:** The government eased **licensing laws** and removed restrictions on industries like telecommunications, finance, and energy.
  - **Tax Reforms:** Reforms were introduced to simplify the **taxation system** and improve tax compliance.
  - **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI):** Policies were liberalized to attract foreign investment in key sectors.
- **Impact:**
  - A **boom in the services sector** (e.g., IT, telecom) transformed India's economy.
  - The economy grew at a **faster pace**, leading to an increase in **foreign exchange reserves** and the creation of a large **middle class**.
  - The reforms also facilitated India's integration into the **global economy**.

## Growth in Key Sectors

- **Agriculture:** Post-Green Revolution, agricultural productivity increased, but growth slowed in the 1980s and 1990s. More recently, the sector has faced challenges like **water scarcity**, **fragmented land holdings**, and **low farm incomes**.
- **Manufacturing:** Manufacturing grew significantly post-liberalization, especially in sectors like **automobiles**, **electronics**, and **chemicals**. However, India's manufacturing sector has faced challenges in competing globally due to high costs and labour market rigidities.
- **Services:** The **services sector** saw phenomenal growth post-1991, with sectors like **information technology (IT)**, **telecommunications**, and **finance** playing a crucial role. India's IT industry, in particular, became a global leader, contributing significantly to GDP and employment.

### Challenges Faced by the Indian Economy

- **Poverty:** Despite high growth rates, poverty remains a significant challenge. A large portion of the population still lives below the poverty line, with access to basic services like healthcare and education being limited in rural areas.
- **Unemployment:** While India has a young population, unemployment remains a critical issue. **Underemployment** and the growth of the informal sector are key concerns. Moreover, the skill gap between labor market demand and available skills is widening.
- **Inflation:** Inflation, particularly food inflation, has remained a recurring challenge. Price volatility in essential goods like food and fuel has a direct impact on the lower-income population.
- **Income Inequality:** Economic growth has resulted in rising **income inequality**, with the benefits of growth being more concentrated in urban and industrial regions, leaving rural areas behind.
- **Infrastructure Deficits:** While there has been significant investment in infrastructure, bottlenecks in areas such as **transportation**, **energy**, and **water management** continue to hamper growth.